

4.8.3 Guidance

Teachers should give students such guidance and instruction as is necessary to ensure that they understand the task they have been given, and know how to set about it. They should explain the basis on which it will be assessed. Teachers should feel free to answer reasonable questions and to discuss students' work with them, until the point where they are working on their final write-up.

A student who takes up and develops advice offered by the teacher should not be penalised for doing so. Teachers should not leave students to muddle along without any understanding of what they are doing. If, however, a student needs to be led all the way through the work, this should be taken into account in the marking, and a note of explanation written on the assessment sheet. Teachers should appreciate that a moderator can usually detect when a student has been given substantial help and that it is to the student's disadvantage if no mention is made of this on the assessment sheet.

Students may discuss a task freely among themselves and may work in small groups. The final write-up must, however, be a student's own work. It is not expected that students will work in larger groups than are necessary.

Coursework may be based on work for another subject (e.g. Geography or Economics), where this is appropriate, but the final write-up must be submitted in a form appropriate for Mathematics.

In order to obtain marks for the assessment domain Oral Communication, students must either give a presentation to the rest of the class, have an interview with the assessor or be engaged in on-going discussion.